

1938, July 18

The following is a faithful transcription of the typewritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

him celebrate and, Thank God, we had a very pleasant celebration of about a week or ten days. Thanks be to God. It was about 12 years since my 20 year sojourn in the Empire State, and Fr. M. J. had, in about 7 years, made quite some friends in the same three stations where I had been located ahead of him. A number of our cousins from Boston and elsewhere, including two nuns, attended the solemn Mass as the climax of the celebration, which, Thank God, "went off without a hitch." The following days we visited our different houses in the East, and besides some friends in N. J.

Shortly after that celebration the Fathers of our Province held a chapter or convention, for election of new superiors and other affairs of the Province. Such chapters, as a rule, are held every 3 years, and everyone is supposed to be ready for a change, if such come. Fortunately, it seemed to me, and providentially, Fr. M. Joachim on this occasion was transferred to one of our largest monasteries, i. e., that of St. Anthony at Marathon, Wisconsin.

Before going thither, however, he got permission to take a week or so vacation to visit old friends and places--notably, in Prescott where we two were born, and "Big River," where we first went to Holy Mass, and to catechism classes, viz., in dear old St. Mary's. Thanks be to God! What colorful memories the mention of these places must awaken in you! They do in me at least and sure you were six when I was born. What a world of experience that meant in advance of the baby!...At all events, Fr. Maurice wrote me shortly after his arrival at St. Antos, of the coming Diamond Jubilee in Prescott, where we were born and baptized, etc., and of a probably invitation that we should attend. Up to this, we had hardly dreamed of Fr. Edward's coming back from the Islands for his Jubilee the following June. Only several months later when the excitement of the Eucharistic Congress at Manila was over, did we learn of his coming. In fact, it was only when he was nearing our shores, in May, that I learned of his actual coming. Not long afterwards, the Pastor of St. Joseph's, in Prescott, not only invited us to the said Jubilee, but about as much as appointed me to give the Jubilee sermon; informing me at the same time that Fr. Edward was to be the Celebrant. Of course I thanked him for the privilege, because, while I never long to go back to any old place from which Divine Providence has seen good to remove me, yet I must acknowledge that I have a natural inclination that way--like the Israelites in the desert naturally yearned (many of them) to go back to Egypt. No doubt, we are all naturally that way